

US Patent & Trademark Office

Patent Public Search | Text View

United States Patent Application Publication

20250280170

Kind Code

A1

Publication Date

September 04, 2025

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GENERATION OF MEDIA STATION PREVIEWS USING A REFERENCE DATABASE

Abstract

In one aspect, an example method includes (i) while a media playback device of a vehicle is playing back content received on a first channel, sending, by the media playback device to a server, a preview request, the preview request identifying a second channel that is different from the first channel; (ii) receiving, by the media playback device from the server, a response to the preview request, the response including identifying information corresponding to content being provided on the second channel; and (iii) while the media playback device is playing back the content received on the first channel, providing, by the media playback device for display, at least a portion of the identifying information corresponding to content being provided on the second channel.

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Appl. No.: 19/210488

Filed: May 16, 2025

Related U.S. Application Data

parent US continuation 18467272 20230914 parent-grant-document US 12342039 child US
19210488

parent US continuation 16718087 20191217 parent-grant-document US 11812102 child US
18467272

us-provisional-application US 62788563 20190104

Publication Classification

Int. Cl.: **H04N21/44** (20110101); **H04N21/2387** (20110101); **H04N21/278** (20110101);
H04N21/439 (20110101); **H04N21/45** (20110101); **H04N21/472** (20110101);
H04N21/81 (20110101)

U.S. Cl.:

CPC **H04N21/44016** (20130101); **H04N21/2387** (20130101); **H04N21/278** (20130101);
H04N21/439 (20130101); **H04N21/4524** (20130101); **H04N21/47217** (20130101);
H04N21/812 (20130101);

Background/Summary

CROSS-REFERENCE TO RELATED APPLICATIONS [0001] The present application is a continuation of U.S. patent application Ser. No. 18/467,272, filed on Sep. 14, 2023, which is a continuation of U.S. patent application Ser. No. 16/718,087, filed on Dec. 17, 2019, now U.S. Pat. No. 11,812,102, which claims priority to U.S. Provisional Patent App. No. 62/788,563, filed on Jan. 4, 2019. The entire disclosure contents of these applications are herewith incorporated by reference into the present application.

USAGE AND TERMINOLOGY

[0002] In this disclosure, unless otherwise specified and/or unless the particular context clearly dictates otherwise, the terms “a” or “an” mean at least one, and the term “the” means the at least one.

[0003] In this disclosure, the term “connection mechanism” means a mechanism that facilitates communication between two or more components, devices, systems, or other entities. A connection mechanism can be a relatively simple mechanism, such as a cable or system bus, or a relatively complex mechanism, such as a packet-based communication network (e.g., the Internet). In some instances, a connection mechanism can include a non-tangible medium (e.g., in the case where the connection is wireless).

[0004] In this disclosure, the term “computing system” means a system that includes at least one computing device. In some instances, a computing system can include one or more other computing systems.

BACKGROUND

[0005] Some media playback devices can display identifying information for content being played back on a channel while the content is being played back. For instance, while a radio is playing a song, a user interface of the radio can display textual information identifying a title, artist, and album of the song.

[0006] A communications protocol referred to as Radio Data System (RDS) allows broadcasters to send identifying information to radios through analog radio waves. Some radio stations transmit audio and other information using digital technology. Transmitting audio and other information over a digital signal allows a radio station to transmit additional types of identifying information, such as album images and artist images. A radio that is capable of receiving digital signals can display a received image that is associated with a song while the radio plays the song.

SUMMARY

[0007] In one aspect, an example method is disclosed. The method includes (i) while a media playback device of a vehicle is playing back content received on a first channel, sending, by the media playback device to a server, a preview request, the preview request identifying a second

channel that is different from the first channel; (ii) receiving, by the media playback device from the server, a response to the preview request, the response including identifying information corresponding to content being provided on the second channel; and (iii) while the media playback device is playing back the content received on the first channel, providing, by the media playback device for display, at least a portion of the identifying information corresponding to content being provided on the second channel.

[0008] In another aspect, an example non-transitory computer-readable medium is disclosed. The computer-readable medium has stored thereon program instructions that upon execution by a processor, cause performance of a set of acts including (i) while a media playback device of a vehicle is playing back content received on a first channel, sending, by the media playback device to a server, a preview request, the preview request identifying a second channel that is different from the first channel; (ii) receiving, by the media playback device from the server, a response to the preview request, the response including identifying information corresponding to content being provided on the second channel; and (iii) while the media playback device is playing back the content received on the first channel, providing, by the media playback device for display, at least a portion of the identifying information corresponding to content being provided on the second channel.

[0009] In another aspect, an example computing system is disclosed. The computing system is configured for performing a set of acts including (i) while a media playback device of a vehicle is playing back content received on a first channel, sending, by the media playback device to a server, a preview request, the preview request identifying a second channel that is different from the first channel; (ii) receiving, by the media playback device from the server, a response to the preview request, the response including identifying information corresponding to content being provided on the second channel; and (iii) while the media playback device is playing back the content received on the first channel, providing, by the media playback device for display, at least a portion of the identifying information corresponding to content being provided on the second channel.

Description

BRIEF DESCRIPTION OF THE DRAWINGS

[0010] FIG. 1 is a simplified block diagram of an example computing device.

[0011] FIG. 2 is a simplified block diagram of an example media preview system.

[0012] FIG. 3 is a simplified block diagram illustrating components of a preview server, media playback device, broadcast monitoring server, station identification system, and media identification system, according to an example embodiment.

[0013] FIG. 4 illustrates an example display provided by a media playback device.

[0014] FIG. 5 is a flow chart of an example method.

DETAILED DESCRIPTION

I. Overview

[0015] Currently, while a media playback device of a vehicle is playing back content received on a first channel, it is difficult to know what content is being provided on other channels that are different from the first channel without tuning away from the first channel. For instance, when listening to content being played back on a first channel by a radio, it is difficult to know what content is being provided on other channels that are different from the first channel without tuning away from the first channel. Similarly, when a user is not interested in content that a media playback device is playing back on a first channel, it is difficult for the user to find content on another channel that the user is interested in without successively tuning in to multiple channels. When searching for different content, the user might not know what content is being provided on another channel before the user tunes in to the channel.

[0016] Disclosed herein are methods and systems to address this and potentially other issues. In an example method, while a media playback device of a vehicle is playing back content received on a first channel, the media playback device can send a preview request to a server. The preview request may identify a second channel that is different from the first channel. The media playback device can then receive from the server a response to the preview request. The response may include identifying information corresponding to content being provided on the second channel. Further, while the media playback device is playing back the content received on the first channel, the media playback device can provide for display at least a portion of the identifying information corresponding to content being provided on the second channel. In this manner, while the media playback device is playing back content received on the first channel, a display can provide an indication of content that is being provided on the second channel, so that a user of the media playback device can decide whether to tune away from the first channel and to the second channel.

[0017] While portions of this disclosure refer to media playback devices that are located in vehicles, the examples are not meant to be limiting. The systems and methods disclosed herein are also applicable to media playback devices that are not located in vehicles, such as portable media playback devices and media playback devices that are located in homes, offices, or other buildings.

[0018] In addition, while portions of this disclosure refer to media playback devices that provide audio content, the examples are not meant to be limiting. The systems and methods are also applicable to media playback devices that provide video content.

II. Example Architecture

A. Computing Device

[0019] FIG. 1 is a simplified block diagram of an example computing device **100**. Computing device **100** can perform various acts and/or functions, such as those described in this disclosure. Computing device **100** can include various components, such as processor **102**, data storage unit **104**, communication interface **106**, and/or user interface **108**. These components can be connected to each other (or to another device, system, or other entity) via connection mechanism **110**.

[0020] Processor **102** can include a general-purpose processor (e.g., a microprocessor) and/or a special-purpose processor (e.g., a digital signal processor (DSP)).

[0021] Data storage unit **104** can include one or more volatile, non-volatile, removable, and/or non-removable storage components, such as magnetic, optical, or flash storage, and/or can be integrated in whole or in part with processor **102**. Further, data storage unit **104** can take the form of a non-transitory computer-readable storage medium, having stored thereon program instructions (e.g., compiled or non-compiled program logic and/or machine code) that, when executed by processor **102**, cause computing device **100** to perform one or more acts and/or functions, such as those described in this disclosure. As such, computing device **100** can be configured to perform one or more acts and/or functions, such as those described in this disclosure. Such program instructions can define and/or be part of a discrete software application. In some instances, computing device **100** can execute program instructions in response to receiving an input, such as from communication interface **106** and/or user interface **108**. Data storage unit **104** can also store other types of data, such as those types described in this disclosure.

[0022] Communication interface **106** can allow computing device **100** to connect to and/or communicate with another entity according to one or more protocols. In one example, communication interface **106** can be a wired interface, such as an Ethernet interface or a high-definition serial-digital-interface (HD-SDI). In another example, communication interface **106** can be a wireless interface, such as a cellular or WI-FI interface. In this disclosure, a connection can be a direct connection or an indirect connection, the latter being a connection that passes through and/or traverses one or more entities, such as a router, switcher, or other network device. Likewise, in this disclosure, a transmission can be a direct transmission or an indirect transmission.

[0023] User interface **108** can facilitate interaction between computing device **100** and a user of computing device **100**, if applicable. As such, user interface **108** can include input components

such as a keyboard, a keypad, a mouse, a touch-sensitive panel, a microphone, and/or a camera, and/or output components such as a display device (which, for example, can be combined with a touch-sensitive panel), a sound speaker, and/or a haptic feedback system. More generally, user interface **108** can include hardware and/or software components that facilitate interaction between computing device **100** and the user of the computing device **100**.

B. Media Preview System

[0024] FIG. **2** is a simplified block diagram of an example media preview system **200**. Media preview system **200** can perform various acts and/or functions related to the delivery and/or presentation of identifying information for media content (e.g., audio content and/or video content), and can be implemented as a computing system.

[0025] Media preview system **200** can include various components, such as a vehicle **210**, content source **220**, preview server **230**, one or more broadcast monitoring servers **240**, station identification system **250**, and media identification system **260**. Vehicle **210** can include a media playback device **212**. Each of media playback device **212**, preview server **230**, broadcast monitoring server(s) **240**, station identification system **250**, and media identification system **260** can be implemented as a computing system.

[0026] Vehicle **210** can be a machine that transports people, such as an automobile, motorcycle, watercraft, or aircraft, for instance. Media playback device **212** of vehicle **210** can include at least one computing device and can take various forms. By way of example, media playback device **212** can include a head unit of vehicle **210**. The head unit can include a display and a user interface that provide a user of vehicle **210** with control over media content presented by vehicle **210**. Although FIG. **2** depicts media playback device **212** as being located in vehicle **210**, in other media preview systems, a media playback device might not be located in a vehicle. For instance, other examples of media playback devices include radios, televisions, smart speakers, and smart displays.

[0027] Media playback device **212** can receive audio content, video content, and/or text content from content source **220**, and can receive this content either directly from content source **220** or indirectly by way of a network **270**. Content source **220** can include a radio station, television station, or web server. For example, content source **220** may be a radio station or radio network that streams or transmits audio over a channel to media playback device **212**, a television (TV) station or TV network that streams or transmits media over a channel to media playback device **212**, and/or a web service that streams or transmits media over network **270** to media playback device **212**.

[0028] Accordingly, media playback device **212** can include a tuner configured to receive an input stream of media content and generate an output stream of media content by processing the input stream. Media playback device **212** can be equipped with tuners, decoders, and other hardware and/or software such that media playback device **212** can access media content that is broadcast by content source **220**. Additionally or alternatively, media playback device **212** can be equipped with network adapters, decoders, and other hardware and/or software such that media playback device **212** can access media content that is distributed through a wide area network (e.g., the internet).

[0029] Media playback device **212** can also include a display or other user interface configured to display identifying information corresponding to media content being provided on one or more respective channels. The display may be a flat-panel screen, a plasma screen, a light emitting diode (LED) screen, or a liquid crystal display (LCD).

[0030] In line with the discussion above, while media playback device **212** is playing back content received on a first channel, media playback device **212** can send a preview request to preview server **230**. The preview request can identify one or more channels that are different from the channel. By way of example, media playback device **212** can be playing back audio content received on a given radio station, and send a preview request that identifies one or more other radio stations. As another example, media playback device **212** can be playing back video content received on a given channel, and send a preview request that identifies one or more other channels.

[0031] In some instances, the preview request can include a station identifier of a second channel. The station identifier can be a call sign of a radio station or a television station, for instance. Additionally or alternatively, the preview request can include a frequency of a second channel and a geographic location of media playback device **212**.

[0032] Media playback device **212** can periodically transmit the preview request to preview server **230**. For instance, media playback device **212** can send the preview request every five or ten seconds, or every minute.

[0033] Preview server **230** can maintain a database that maps a plurality of channels to identifying information corresponding to content being provided on the plurality of channels. As an example, preview server **230** can maintain a database mapping radio stations to audio content (e.g. songs or shows) currently being broadcast by the radio stations. As another example, preview server **230** can maintain a database mapping television stations to video content currently being broadcast by the television stations. As described more fully below, preview server **230** can update the database using data that is received from broadcast monitoring server(s) **240**, station identification system **250**, and media identification system **260**.

[0034] Broadcast monitoring server(s) **240** can provide to preview server **230** data related to content that is being provided on the plurality of channels. For example, broadcast monitoring server(s) **240** can periodically or upon request provide to preview server **230** a list of channels and corresponding content that is being provided on those channels. In some examples, broadcast monitoring server(s) **240** can identify content that is being provided on the channels using audio or video fingerprinting. Additionally or alternatively, broadcast monitoring server(s) **240** can identify audio content being provided on one or more channels based on data provided by programming software that radio stations utilize to program which songs are played. In some examples, broadcast monitoring server(s) **240** can provide to preview server **230** a media sample that is being provided on a channel.

[0035] In the database that preview server **230** maintains, each channel can be assigned a unique identifier for indexing purposes. The unique identifier can be a unique number, for instance. Station identification system **250** can be configured to receive a channel identifier from preview server **230**, determine a unique identifier corresponding to the channel identifier, and provide the unique identifier to preview server **230**. Station identification system **250** can convert channel identifiers to unique identifiers using mapping data. For instance, station identification system **250** can convert a radio station call sign to a unique identifier using mapping data that maps call signs to unique identifiers. As another example, station identification system **250** can convert a channel frequency and a geographic location to a unique identifier using mapping data that maps channel frequencies and associated geographic locations to unique identifiers.

[0036] Media identification system **260** can provide to preview server **230** identifying information corresponding to content being provided on one or more second channels. For instance, media identification system **260** can maintain a database mapping song titles to identifying information. As another example, media identification system can maintain a database mapping video titles to identifying information. With this approach, preview server **230** can provide the title of media content being provided on a channel to media identification system **260**. Media identification system **260** can then determine identifying information corresponding to the title of the media content using the database, and provide the identifying information to preview server **230**.

[0037] Additionally or alternatively, preview server **230** can provide a media sample of content being provided on a channel to media identification system **260**. With this approach, media identification system **260** can identify the content from the media sample using fingerprinting, and determine identifying information corresponding to the identified content.

[0038] The identifying information that media identification system provides to preview server **230** can take various forms. For example, the identifying information can include a media unique identifier (e.g., a track unique identifier (TUI). For audio content, the identifying information can

include a track title, album title, and artist name. Additionally or alternatively, the identifying information can include an album image (e.g., cover art) or artist image. The identifying information can also include a program identifier that identifies an audio program. Similarly, for video content, the identifying information can include a title and a program identifier that identifies a video program. In some instances, the content being provided on one of the second channels can include a sporting event, and the identifying information can include time and score information for the sporting event.

[0039] After receiving the preview request, preview server **230** can query the database to correlate one or more channels identified in the preview request (or related to a channel identified in the preview request) to identifying information corresponding to content being provided on the one or more channels. Preview server **230** can then send a response to the preview request to media playback device **212**. The response can include identifying information corresponding to content being provided on the one or more channels identified in the preview request.

[0040] After receiving the response, media playback device **212** can provide at least a portion of the identifying information for display. Media playback device **212** can provide for display identifying information corresponding to content being provided on one or more second channels while the media playback device is playing back content that is received on a first channel.

[0041] Additionally or alternatively, media playback device **212** can provide at least a portion of the identifying information to another device for display. For instance, media playback device **212** can provide a portion of the identifying information to another component of vehicle **210** for display.

[0042] Network **270** may be any network that enables communication between devices, such as a wired network and/or a wireless network (e.g., a mobile network).

[0043] FIG. **3** is a simplified block diagram illustrating components of media playback device **212**, preview server **230**, broadcast monitoring server(s) **240**, station identification system **250**, and media identification system **260**. As shown in FIG. **3**, media playback device **212** includes a request generator **214**, a local database **216**, and a user interface **218**, all configured to communicate with each other (e.g., via a bus, shared memory, or switch). Further, preview server **230** includes a preview generator **232** and a mapping database **234**, configured to communicate with each other. Still further, station identification system **250** includes an index module **252**, and media identification system **260** includes an identification module **262**. Still further, broadcast monitoring server(s) **240** includes a broadcast monitoring server **240a**, a broadcast monitoring server **240b**, and a broadcast monitoring server **240c**.

[0044] One or more of the components depicted in FIG. **3** can be implemented using hardware (e.g., a processor of a machine, a field-programmable gate array (FPGA), or an application-specific integrated circuit (ASIC), or a combination of hardware and software. Moreover, any two or more of the components depicted in FIG. **3** can be combined into a single component, and the function described herein for a single component can be subdivided among multiple components.

[0045] In line with the discussion above, broadcast monitoring servers **240a**, **240b**, and **240c** can provide data related to content being provided on various channels to preview server **230**. More particularly, as shown in FIG. **3**, broadcast monitoring server **240a** can provide data in the form of text and station identifier pairings for multiple channels. For instance, for each pairing, the text can include a song title and artist as well as a channel identifier for a channel on which the song is being provided. Alternatively, for each pairing, the text can include a video title as well as a channel on which the video is being provided.

[0046] Broadcast monitoring server **240a** can determine the pairings using audio and/or video fingerprinting. Fingerprinting can involve obtaining a query fingerprint from a sample of media content, comparing the query fingerprint to known reference fingerprints, and determining that the query fingerprint matches at least one known reference fingerprint. Determining that the query fingerprint matches at least one known fingerprint can involve determining that a similarity

between the query fingerprint and at least one of the known reference fingerprints satisfies a predetermined threshold. The predetermined threshold can be associated with a Tanimoto distance measurement, a Manhattan distance measurement, or other distance measurements. Broadcast monitoring server **240a** can also use other matching techniques, such as Euclidian, Cosine, KL-Divergence, and/or Itakura matching techniques, to match the query fingerprint to at least one known reference fingerprint.

[0047] Broadcast monitoring server **240b** can provide data in the form of media sample and station identifier pairings for one or more channels. For example, for one or more channels, broadcast monitoring server **240b** may publish media samples of content that is being provided on the respective channels along with station identifiers for the respective channels. Each sample can include multiple frames of audio content or multiple frames of video content.

[0048] Broadcast monitoring server **240c** can provide data in the form of text and/or media sample and station identifier pairings. In one example, broadcast monitoring server **240c** can identify audio content being provided on one or more channels based on data provided by programming software that radio stations utilize to program which songs are played. After a radio station begins playing a song, the programming software can publish data regarding the song. Broadcast monitoring server **240c** can access the published data to determine the song. The published data can include text and/or a media sample for each of one or more channels.

[0049] Data received by preview server **230** from broadcast monitoring servers **240a**, **240b**, and **240c** can be used to populate mapping database **235**. In some examples, populating mapping database **234** using data obtained from multiple different broadcast monitoring servers can allow preview server **230** to establish a robust database that maps channels to content. For instance, preview server **230** can retrieve a first set of data for a first set of channels from broadcast monitoring server **240a**, and preview server **230** can retrieve a second set of data for a second set of channels from broadcast monitoring server **240b**, with the second set of channels including some channels that are not included in the first set of channels.

[0050] Upon receiving text and/or media sample and station identifier pairings for one or more channels, preview server **230** can communicate with media identification system **260** to determine identifying information for the content being provided on the channels represented within the pairings. More particularly, for each of one or more channels represented by the pairings, preview server **230** can send to identification module **262** of media identification system **260** the text or media sample corresponding to the channel. Identification module **262** can then process the text or media sample for each channel, and determine identifying information corresponding to the text or media sample. For instance, identification module **262** can match received text to an item of media content represented in a database of media identification system **260**, and determine a media unique identifier (e.g., a track unique identifier) corresponding to the item of media content. Alternatively, identification module **262** can identify an item of media content that includes a received media sample using audio or video fingerprinting, and determine a media unique identifier corresponding to the item of media content.

[0051] After identifying an item of media content corresponding to text and/or a media sample, identification module **262** can provide the media unique identifier for the item of media content to preview server for storage in mapping database **234** of preview server **230**. Instead of or in addition to the media unique identifier, identification module **262** can provide other identifying information associated with an item of media content to preview server **230**. By way of example, for audio content, the identifying information can include a track title, album title, and artist name.

Additionally or alternatively, the identifying information can include an album image (e.g., cover art) or artist image. The identifying information can also include a program identifier that identifies an audio program. Similarly, for video content, the identifying information can include a title and a program identifier that identifies a video program. In some instances, the content being provided on one of the second channels can include a sporting event, and the identifying information can

include time and score information for the sporting event.

[0052] Upon receiving text and/or media sample pairings for one or more channels, preview server **230** can also communicate with station identification system **250** to determine unique identifiers for the channels represented within the pairings. More particularly, for each of one or more channels represented by the pairings, preview server **230** can send to index module **252** of station identification system **262** a channel identifier of the channel. Index module **252** can then use mapping data to convert the channel identifier to a unique identifier, and provide the unique identifier to preview server **230**. Preview server **230** can then use the unique identifier to store identifying information for the channel in mapping database **234**.

[0053] The identifying information stored in mapping database **234** for each channel may be updated when broadcast monitoring servers **240a**, **240b**, and **240c** provide new data to preview server **230**. In some instances, one or more of broadcast monitoring servers **240a**, **240b**, and **240c** may periodically push data to preview server **230**. Alternatively, preview server **230** can periodically pull data from one or more of broadcast monitoring servers **240a**, **240b**, and **240c**.

[0054] While media playback device **212** is playing back content received on a first channel, request generator **214** of media playback device **210** can generate a preview request and provide the preview request to preview server **230**. The preview request can identify one or more second channels that are different from the first channel. In some examples, the preview request can include a station identifier for each of the one or more second channels. The station identifier(s) can be call signs, for instance. Additionally or alternatively, the preview request can include a frequency of a second channel and a geographic location of the media playback device **212**.

[0055] Request generator **214** can select the second channel(s) identified in the preview request in various ways. As one example, request generator **214** can select the second channels of the preview request based on a characteristic of the first channel. For instance, based on the first channel being associated with a first genre (e.g., blues, jazz, country, etc.), request generator **214** can select channels that are also associated with the first genre. As another example, request generator **214** can select the channels of the preview request based on channels that are programmed as presets of media playback device **212**. As still another example, request generator **214** can select as the second channels one or more other channels that are located within a frequency range or channel range of the first channel. For instance, request generator **214** can select the next two adjacent channels that are above the first channel and the next two adjacent channels that are below the first channel. If the first channel is channel **124**, request generator **214** could select channels **122**, **123**, **125**, and **126**. Or if the first channel is assigned to a frequency of 98.1 megahertz (MHz), request generator **214** could select second channels assigned to frequencies of 96.9 MHz, 97.3 MHz, 98.9 MHz, and 99.5 MHz based on those channels being the channels that are adjacent to the first channel in a particular geographic area.

[0056] Upon receiving the preview request, preview generator **232** of preview server **230** can retrieve identifying information corresponding to content being provided on one or more channels identified in the preview request, and provide the identifying information to media playback device **212** in an output response. To facilitate this retrieval, preview generator **232** can send one or more channel identifiers for channels listed in the preview request to station identification system **250**. Index module **252** of station identification system **250** can then respond to preview generator **232** with unique identifiers for the channels.

[0057] Further, preview generator **232** can then use the unique identifiers to retrieve identifying information for the channels from mapping database **234**. After obtaining the identifying information, preview generator **232** can generate an output response that includes identifying information for the channels, and provide the output response to media playback device **212**. The output response can be in the form of text data, such as a listing of channels and corresponding identifying information. The identifying information can include one or more links to image data, such as a link to album art or a link to an image of a song artist or an image of a program host.

[0058] In some examples, preview generator **232** might not be able to retrieve identifying information for a channel identified in the preview request. Upon determining that identifying information for a channel is unavailable, the preview generator **232** can add the channel to a list or increment a count associated with the channel. This data regarding how often identifying information for a channel is requested but unavailable can be stored by preview server **230** and, upon request, can be provided to one of broadcast monitoring servers **240a**, **240b**, or **240c**. The broadcast monitoring server that receives the data can then enhance their service, by adding the station to a list of stations that are monitored by the broadcast monitoring server.

[0059] Upon receiving the output response, media playback device **212** can store the identifying information for the channels in local database **216** of media playback device **212**. Media playback device **212** can display a portion of the identifying information using user interface **218**. For example, media playback device **212** can display respective identifying information for multiple channels in respective user interface elements (e.g., respective tiles) corresponding to each channel of the multiple channels. The identifying information can be displayed in a now-playing guide that is accessible via user interface **218**. In some instances, the identifying information can be displayed adjacent to identifying information for the first channel. Alternatively, when the identifying information is displayed, identifying information for the first channel might not be visible within user interface **218**.

[0060] In some instances, the preview request can identify the first channel on which media playback device **212** is playing back content rather than identifying one or more second channels that are different from the first channel. With this approach, preview generator **232** can select one or more second channels based on the first channel, determine identifying information corresponding to content being provided on the one or more second channels, and send the identifying information to media playback device **212** within an output response. For example, preview server **230** can determine that the first channel is associated with a first genre, and select one or more second channels that are also associated with the second genre. Alternatively, preview server **230** can determine that the first channel is associated with a first geographic location (e.g., a first city), and select one or more second channels that are popular in the first city.

[0061] Further, in some instances, upon receiving a preview request, preview generator **232** can also select an advertisement, and send the advertisement to media playback device **212** within the output response. Media playback device **212** can then provide the advertisement for display when displaying identifying information that is included within the output response. An owner of an item of media content or a third party may pay a fee to associate an advertisement with the item. With this arrangement, preview generator **232** can determine that an item of media content that is playing on a channel has an associated advertisement and that identifying information for the item of media content will be provided to media playback device **212** in an output response. Based on making this determination, preview generator **232** can include the advertisement in the output response, for display in conjunction with the identifying information.

[0062] Other advertisement arrangements are also possible. For instance, a third party may pay a fee to associate an advertisement with a particular channel or group of channels. Upon determining that identifying information for one of the channels is to be included in an output response, preview generator **232** can then select the advertisement for inclusion in the output response.

[0063] FIG. 4 illustrates an example display **400** that a media playback device, such as media playback device **212**, can provide. As shown in FIG. 4, display **400** includes four identification elements **402**, **406**, **410**, and **414** corresponding to four respective identifying-information tiles **404**, **408**, **412**, **416**. Each of the identification elements **402**, **406**, **410**, and **414** displays data indicative of a respective channel. The data indicative of a respective channel can, for example, include a frequency, channel name, channel identifier (e.g., call sign), genre, and/or channel logo.

[0064] Further, each of the identifying-information tiles **404**, **408**, **412**, and **416** displays identifying information for content being provided on a corresponding channel. In particular, identifying-

information tile **404** displays identifying information for content being provided on a first channel identified by identification element **402**, identifying-information tile **408** displays identifying information for content being provided on a second channel identified by identification element **406**, identifying-information tile **412** displays identifying information for content being provided on a third channel identified by identification element **410**, and identifying-information tile **416** displays identifying information for content being provided on a fourth channel identified by identification element **414**. Hence, display **400** may allow a user of the media playback device to visually browse what's playing across multiple channels, thereby simplifying media content search and discovery.

[0065] For the display **400**, the fourth channel is the currently selected channel. In other words, the media playback device displays identification elements **402**, **406**, **410**, and **414** and identifying-information tiles **404**, **408**, **412**, and **416** while the media playback device is playing back content that is received on the fourth channel. To notify a user that media playback device is playing back content that is received on the fourth channel, data indicative of the fourth channel and identifying information for the content being provided on the fourth channel is displayed in a current-channel element **418**.

[0066] Further, each identification element **402**, **406**, **410**, and **414** and/or each identifying-information tile **404**, **408**, **412**, and **416** may be selectable by a user of the media playback device. For instance, a user can select identification element **402** or identifying-information tile **404** to cause the media playback device to switch from the fourth channel tune to the first channel.

[0067] In other examples, the media playback device might be playing back content that is received on a fifth channel that is different from each of the first channel, second channel, third channel, and fourth channel. With this approach, data indicative of the fifth channel and identifying information for the content being provided on the fifth channel can be displayed in the current-channel element **418** (not shown).

[0068] As further shown in FIG. 4, display **400** can optionally include an advertisement **420**. The advertisement may include text and/or an image, for instance. The advertisement may have been provided to the media playback device along with the identifying information that is being displayed in the identifying-information tiles **404**, **408**, **412**, and **416**.

III. Example Operations

[0069] FIG. 5 is a flow chart of an example method **500**. Method **500** can be carried out by a media playback device, such as media playback device **212** or more generally, by a computing system. At block **502**, method **500** includes while a media playback device of a vehicle is playing back content received on a first channel, sending, by the media playback device to a server, a preview request. The preview request identifies a second channel that is different from the first channel. At block **504**, method **500** includes receiving, by the media playback device from the server, a response to the preview request. The response includes identifying information corresponding to content being provided on the second channel. And at block **506**, method **500** includes while the media playback device is playing back the content received on the first channel, providing, by the media playback device for display, at least a portion of the identifying information corresponding to content being provided on the second channel.

IV. Example Variations

[0070] Although some of the acts and/or functions described in this disclosure have been described as being performed by a particular entity, the acts and/or functions can be performed by any entity, such as those entities described in this disclosure. Further, although the acts and/or functions have been recited in a particular order, the acts and/or functions need not be performed in the order recited. However, in some instances, it can be desired to perform the acts and/or functions in the order recited. Further, each of the acts and/or functions can be performed responsive to one or more of the other acts and/or functions. Also, not all of the acts and/or functions need to be performed to achieve one or more of the benefits provided by this disclosure, and therefore not all of the acts

and/or functions are required.

[0071] Although certain variations have been discussed in connection with one or more examples of this disclosure, these variations can also be applied to all of the other examples of this disclosure as well.

[0072] Although select examples of this disclosure have been described, alterations and permutations of these examples will be apparent to those of ordinary skill in the art. Other changes, substitutions, and/or alterations are also possible without departing from the invention in its broader aspects as set forth in the following claims.

Claims

1. A computer-implemented method comprising: determining, while a media playback device is playing back content broadcast on a first channel associated with a first genre, a second channel that is associated with the first genre and has a frequency within a threshold frequency range of a first frequency of the first channel; receiving, in response to determining the second channel, identifying information corresponding to content being broadcast on the second channel; and providing for display, while the media playback device is playing back the content broadcast on the first channel, at least a portion of the identifying information corresponding to the content being broadcast on the second channel.
2. The method of claim 1, wherein the content broadcast on the first channel is audio content.
3. The method of claim 1, wherein the content broadcast on the first channel is video content.
4. The method of claim 1, further comprising: sending a preview request identifying the second channel, wherein the identifying information is received in response to the preview request.
5. The method of claim 4, wherein the preview request comprises a call sign of a broadcast station that broadcasts the content on the second channel.
6. The method of claim 4, wherein the preview request comprises a frequency of the second channel and a geographic location of the media playback device.
7. The method of claim 4, wherein the preview request comprises a set of second channels that includes the second channel, and wherein receiving the identifying information further comprises receiving identifying information corresponding to respective content being broadcast on each channel of the set of second channels.
8. The method of claim 7, wherein the set of second channels is selected based on channels programmed as presets of the media playback device.
9. The method of claim 1, wherein the identifying information is in a response further comprising an advertisement, wherein providing for display at least a portion of the identifying information further comprises providing for display the advertisement.
10. The method of claim 1, wherein the identifying information corresponding to the content being broadcast on the second channel comprises a media unique identifier.
11. The method of claim 1, wherein the identifying information corresponding to the content being broadcast on the second channel comprises a track title, album title, and artist name.
12. The method of claim 1, wherein the identifying information corresponding to the content being broadcast on the second channel comprises a program identifier.
13. The method of claim 1, wherein the identifying information corresponding to the content being broadcast on the second channel comprises a link to an image.
14. The method of claim 1, wherein providing for display the at least a portion of the identifying information comprises providing the at least a portion of the identifying information for display on a user interface of the media playback device.
15. A tangible, non-transitory computer readable medium comprising instructions that, when executed, cause at least one processor to perform a set of operations comprising: determining, while a media playback device is playing back content broadcast on a first channel associated with

a first genre, a second channel that is associated with the first genre and has a frequency within a threshold frequency range of a first frequency of the first channel; receiving, in response to determining the second channel, identifying information corresponding to content being broadcast on the second channel; and providing for display, while the media playback device is playing back the content broadcast on the first channel, at least a portion of the identifying information corresponding to the content being broadcast on the second channel.

16. The tangible, non-transitory computer readable medium of claim 15, wherein the set of operations further comprise: sending a preview request identifying the second channel, wherein the identifying information is received in response to the preview request.

17. The tangible, non-transitory computer readable medium of claim 16, wherein the preview request comprises a set of second channels that includes the second channel, and wherein receiving the identifying information further comprises receiving identifying information corresponding to respective content being broadcast on each channel of the set of second channels.

18. A computing device comprising: at least one processor; and a tangible, non-transitory computer readable medium comprising instructions that, when executed, cause the at least one processor to perform a set of operations comprising: determining, while a media playback device is playing back content broadcast on a first channel associated with a first genre, a second channel that is associated with the first genre and has a frequency within a threshold frequency range of a first frequency of the first channel; receiving, in response to determining the second channel, identifying information corresponding to content being broadcast on the second channel; and providing for display, while the media playback device is playing back the content broadcast on the first channel, at least a portion of the identifying information corresponding to the content being broadcast on the second channel.

19. The computing device of claim 18, wherein the set of operations further comprise: sending a preview request identifying the second channel, wherein the identifying information is received in response to the preview request.

20. The computing device of claim 19, wherein the preview request comprises a set of second channels that includes the second channel, and wherein receiving the identifying information further comprises receiving identifying information corresponding to respective content being broadcast on each channel of the set of second channels.
